Writing Technique

Year 4 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Easy: What technique is used in "The wind whispered through the trees"?

Answer: Personification — the wind is given the human action of whispering.

Standard: Which is more powerful: "The dog ran" or "The dog sprinted, ears flapping in the wind"?

Answer: The second — it uses a precise verb and vivid detail to show the action, rather than just telling us what happened.

Advanced: Identify TWO techniques in: "The wind howled like a wolf and tore at the trees."

Answer: Simile ("like a wolf") and personification (the wind "tore" — a violent, deliberate action).

Easy / Standard (15 questions)

1. Which technique is used in "The wind whispered through the trees"? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration
2. What technique compares two things using the words 'like' or 'as'? Name the technique.
3. Identify the technique used in this sentence: "Busy bees buzzed by the bright blooms."
4. Which sentence uses a simile? A) The moon was a silver coin. B) The moon smiled down at us. C) The moon was as bright as a torch. D) The moon glowed softly.
5. Write your own simile to describe a stormy sea.
6. What technique is used in "The balloon went POP!"? Explain why the writer chose this word.
7. Underline the powerful verb in this sentence and explain why it is better than 'walked': "She marched proudly into the room."
8. Which sentence is an example of alliteration? A) Slippery snakes slithered silently. B) The cat sat down. C) Birds flew high. D) Rain fell softly.
9. Select ALL the sentences that use personification: A) The leaves danced in the wind. B) The car was fast. C) The sun smiled down on us. D) The dog barked loudly.
10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The dog ran." B) "The dog sprinted, ears flapping in the wind."
11. What technique is used in "Thunder crashed and boomed overhead"? Name it.
12. Write a metaphor to describe a brave person.
13. Which sentence begins with an adverb to open the sentence in a more interesting way? A) Quickly, she grabbed her bag. B) She grabbed her bag quickly. C) The girl grabbed her bag. D) Her bag was grabbed.
14. Identify the technique used in this sentence: "The stars winked at the sleepy world."
15. Select ALL the words below that are powerful (precise) verbs rather than plain, overused ones: A) walked B) trudged C) went D) sprinted

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Standard (15 questions)

1. What is the difference between a simile and a metaphor? Give one example of each.
2. Which sentence uses a metaphor (not a simile)? A) The classroom was a zoo. B) The classroom was as noisy as a zoo. C) The classroom seemed like a zoo. D) The classroom sounded like a zoo.
3. Identify the technique and explain its effect: "The rain hammered against the window."
4. Rewrite this sentence to include a powerful verb instead of 'went': "She went across the room."
5. Which sentence shows rather than tells the reader that a character is nervous? A) Tom was nervous. B) Tom felt scared. C) Tom's hands trembled as he gripped the microphone. D) Tom was worried about speaking.
6. Select ALL the sentences below that use onomatopoeia: A) The fire crackled and hissed. B) The fire was hot. C) The tyres screeched to a halt. D) The car was fast.
7. Write a sentence using personification to describe an angry storm.
8. Which technique is used in "Sammy the snail slowly slid across the soil"? A) simile B) alliteration C) metaphor D) onomatopoeia
9. Explain why starting a sentence with "Before the sun had risen," is more effective than "The sun had not risen yet and she got up."
10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The fire was big and hot." B) "Flames roared and devoured everything in their path."
11. Identify TWO techniques used in this sentence: "The jagged rocks bit into her feet like tiny knives."
12. Which sentence opens with a preposition phrase rather than the subject? A) Beneath the old oak tree, the children played. B) The children played beneath the old oak tree. C) The children were playing. D) They played under the tree.
13. Select ALL the sentence openers below that add variety (i.e. do NOT simply start with the subject): A) Slowly, the tortoise crept forward. B) The tortoise crept forward slowly. C) Without warning, the storm arrived. D) The storm arrived without warning.
14. Write a sentence that 'shows' a character is excited, without using the word 'excited'.
15. Identify the technique and explain why the writer chose it: "The old house groaned and creaked in the wind."

Standard / Hard (15 questions)

1. Identify the technique and explain its effect: "The waves clapped against the shore."
2. Which sentence contains BOTH a simile and personification? A) The wind howled like a wolf and tore at the trees. B) The wind was cold and strong. C) The wind blew against the window. D) The wind felt icy.
3. Rewrite this 'telling' sentence as a 'showing' sentence: "The boy was excited."
4. What is an "extended metaphor"? Give a short example.
5. Which sentence uses onomatopoeia to build tension? A) The floorboard creaked beneath her foot. B) The floorboard was old. C) The floor made a noise. D) She stepped on the floorboard.
6. Identify the technique used in this sentence and explain its effect: "Hope flickered inside her."
7. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why: A) "The fire was big and hot." B) "Flames roared and licked at the old barn."
8. Select ALL the sentences below that use personification. A) The leaves danced in the breeze. B) The leaves were orange. C) The moon smiled down on the village. D) The moon was full.
9. Identify the simile in this sentence and explain what it compares: "Her voice was as soft as a whisper."

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10. Which sentence opens with a subordinate clause? A) Although she was nervous, she smiled. B) She smiled although she was nervous. C) She was nervous but smiled. D) Nervous, she smiled.

11. Write one sentence describing a thunderstorm using personification.

12. Explain the effect of the powerful verb 'snatched' in: "He snatched the last biscuit."

13. Select ALL the sentences below that use a strong, precise verb instead of 'said'. A) "Stop!" she yelled. B) "Stop!" she said. C) "I'm scared," he whispered. D) "I'm scared," he said.

14. Write two short sentences describing a sunset: one using a simile, one using a metaphor.

15. Identify the technique and explain why it suits a description of silence: "The silence pressed on her ears."

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